Heidi's Portfolio

This is the export of the portfolio at heidi.si from 20/10/2026, 12:03:55. Please review the website for the updated version.

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Artist Statement

Through my work I explore queer representation and the societal implications of technology through the mediums of AI, virtual reality, web technologies, data visualisation, as well as collecting, matching, and collaging items and concepts. My work engages critically with art and technology, investigating how they can illuminate the often-invisible narratives of marginalized communities.

By creating projects such as “mrge”, which transforms the experiences of a micro-audience (transmasculine individuals) into accessible, high-production value product, I question how capitalism sets priorities on which societal groups are being represented in commercial production, thus shifting the focus from profit-driven narratives to the possibilities of smaller, experimental engagements. At the same time, I aim to also practically demonstrate the biases present in generative AI, revealing both its limitations and its potential for empowerment.

My artistic practice is rooted in a commitment to exploring the societal impacts of technology, grounded in personal experiences that shape my understanding of reality and personal identity.

Inspired by the aesthetics of modern web and graphic design, net art and critical digital practices, as well as my past work as a web developer and UX designer, I strive to create works that offer alternative ways to consider the complexities of our digital age.

As I look to the future, I am driven to develop commercial-quality experiences that defy convention and profitability-first thinking, while remaining deeply connected to the communities and cultures they represent. I’m curious to further explore the topics of (dis)information, surveillance, migration, neurodiversity, and activism.

Through my practice, I hope to inspire conversations that challenge the status quo and reconsider the role of technology in shaping our collective experience.

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Name	Tags	Created	Size
Parent Directory	–	–	-
mrge/	generative AI, LGBT, social game	2024-10-08 11:30	13ME
opet-ista-priča/	storytelling, discrimination, hackathon	2018-12-10 12:01	1.5ME
once-upon-a-train/	audio, location-based, AR	2017-05-11 18:56	9.1ME
junk-calendar-2026/	collage, anti-consumerism	2025-12-08 11:22	10ME
lesbian-quarter-2024/	festival, archive, LGBT, design	2024-05-01 11:01	69ME

mrge

50 scannable trading cards, AI-generated images, web platform Visit >

Name	Tags	Created	Size
↑ Parent Directory	generative AI, LGBT, social game	2024-10-08 11:30	13MB

Project Description

“mrge” is a trading card game with a digital twist designed for transmasculine individuals who are looking to start weightlifting to aid their body transformation.

It was launched and presented at the TransCon in Ljubljana in November 2024.

The project consists of 12-card packs and an educational website. Each card is connected with a QR code on the back, linking to a web page with more information about that particular topic.



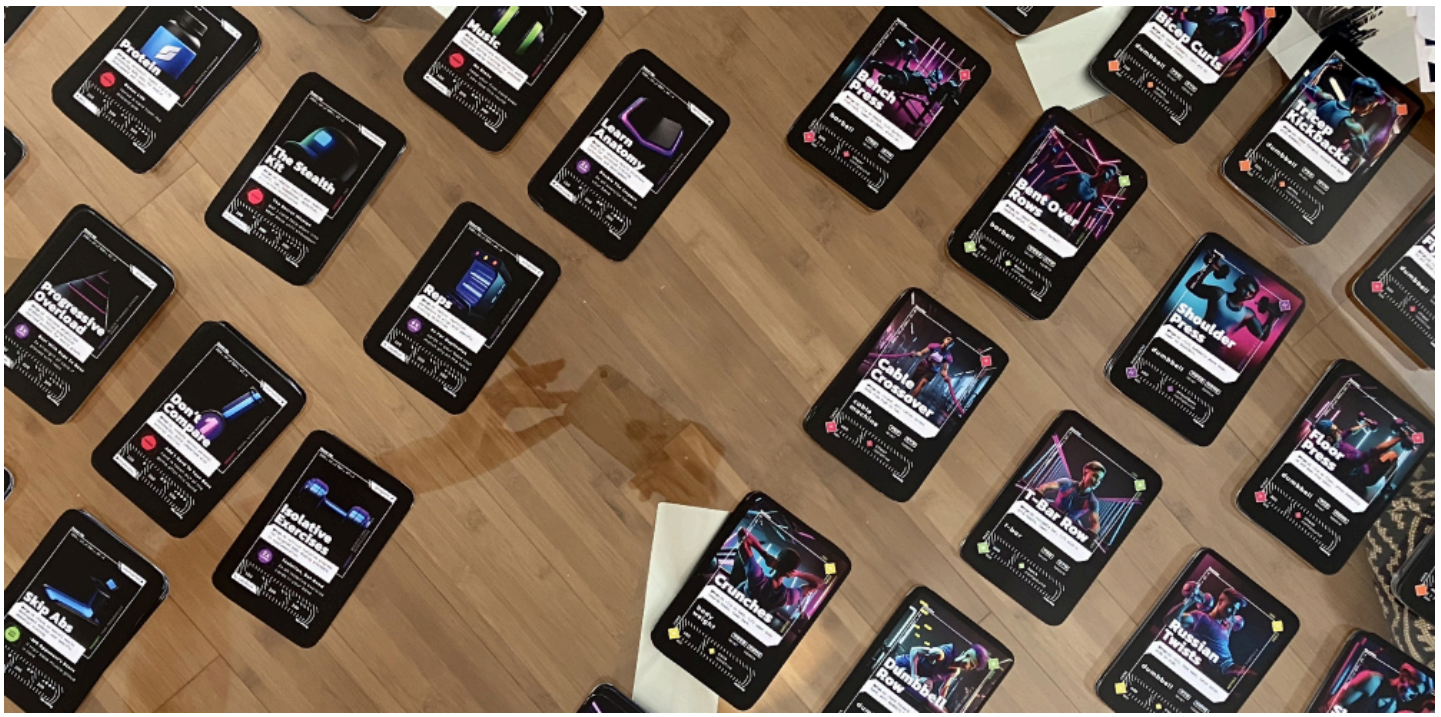
Technical Details

The first person to scan each card is able to “unlock” it on the website, making it visible to everyone. For selected cards, they may also claim a free prize (water bottles, caps, weightlifting gear, stickers, access to a buddy-up group, special gym music playlists, etc.).

The graphics, as well as the content and the gameplay, were created by generative AI, aided by a human designing the cards, web development, research, reviewing and fact-checking. Each card represents one tip for weightlifting or one exercise. Currently, there

are 50 different cards available to be collected (view the full list here). The card packs are completely free for the end users.

I chose the name “mrge” because, in Slovenian, it means an equivalent of “beefcakes,” and it’s usually used in a masculine context but grammatically neutral.



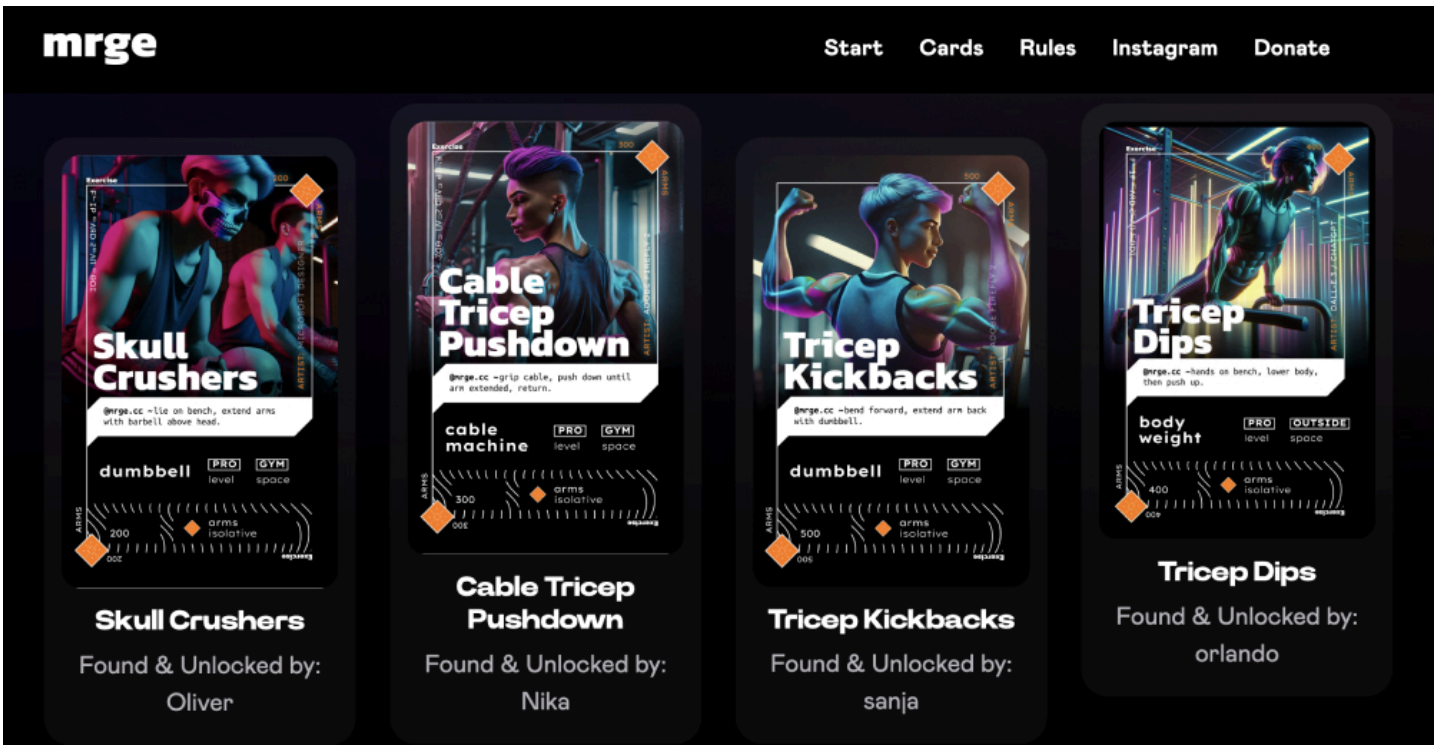
Context and Significance

The way production is managed and prioritised in our system is based on the commercial interest and profitability. Marginalised communities do not have access to tailored products and services. The idea of mrge was to produce a high production value product aimed at an extremely narrow community — transmasculine individuals.

Gyms, as they currently exist, are often unwelcoming spaces for transgender individuals. At a professional level, sports are inherently binary, with limited interaction between the two sexes. This segregation extends to amateur settings, where distinct spaces such as bathrooms, locker rooms, and showers can lead to discomfort and awkward encounters for those who do not conform to traditional gender norms. My own experiences navigating these obstacles inspired the creation of this project.

As I started working on this project, I encountered obvious biases in generative AI. While I anticipated some level of bias, the extent was surprising. The LLM training data frequently lacks the nuanced understanding of the terms like transgender, non-binary, and transmasculine, and tiptoes around the related terms like LGBT and queer, at times blocking and censoring output related to these terms, despite the prompts being perfectly appropriate.

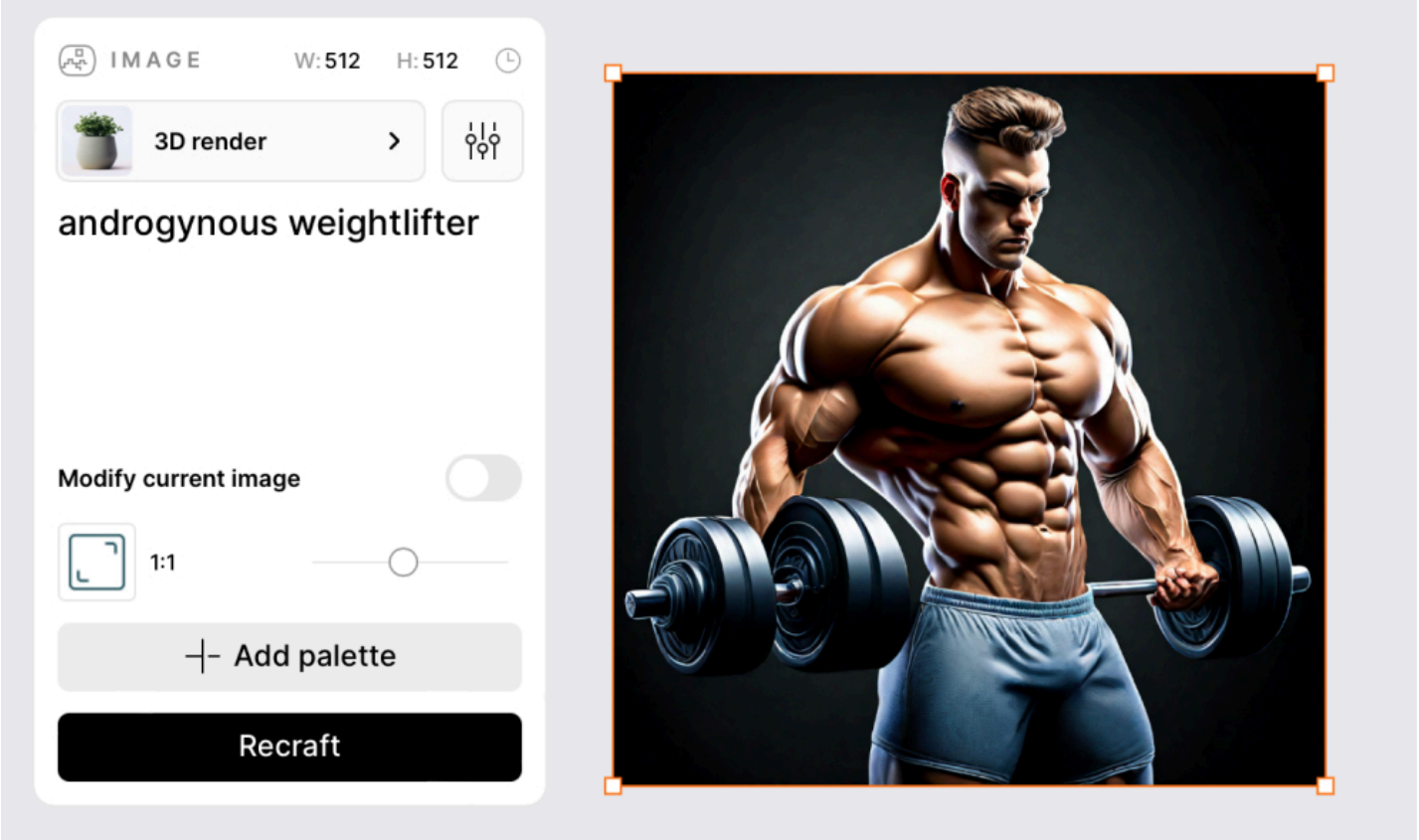
More broadly, fitness-related prompts typically produce images of bodies that conform to societal beauty standards: usually white, extremely fit, and with no visible disabilities. LLMs do not “know” what a visibly queer body looks like, and generate characters that seem to visually fit the gender binary.



Examples and Models Used

Recraft AI is a fantastic tool that allows users to generate very consistent graphics; I used it to generate some of the cards.

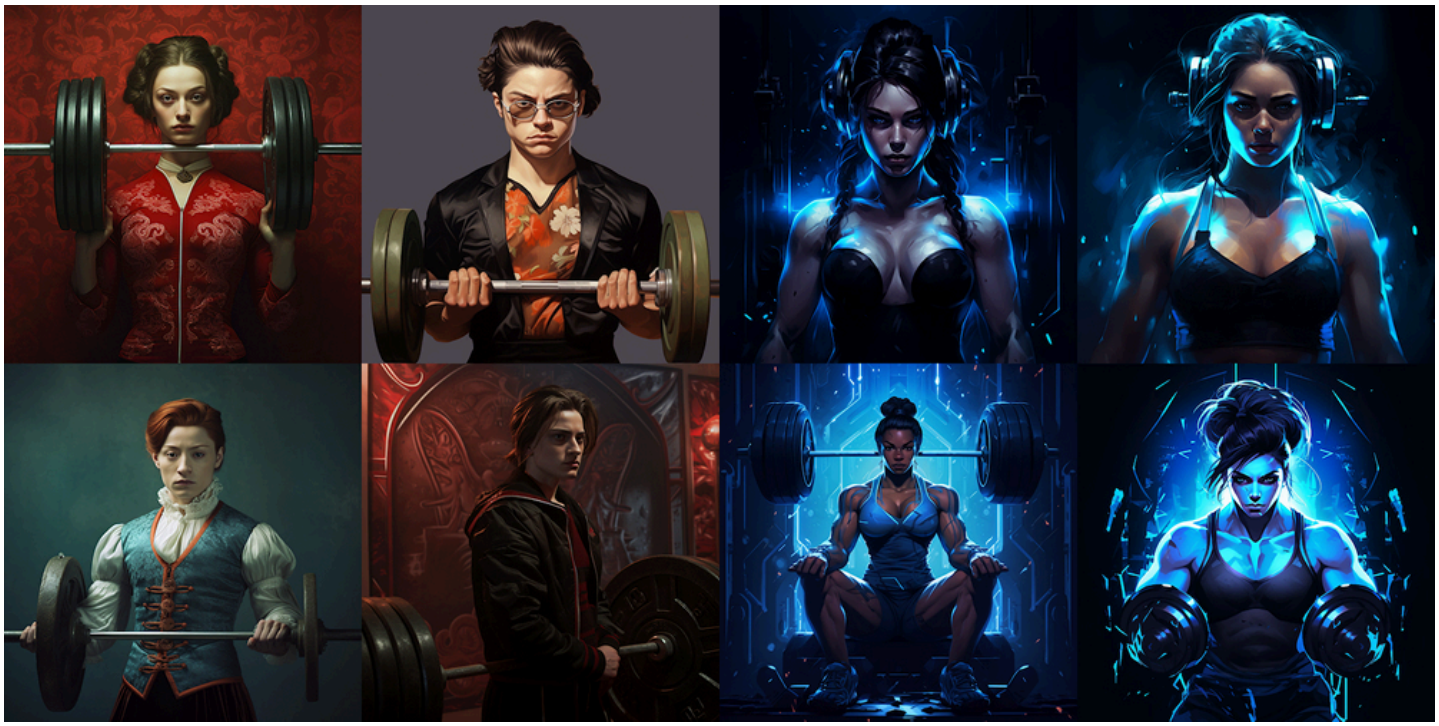
However, when it came to human characters, the models were overly-tuned, as seen below.



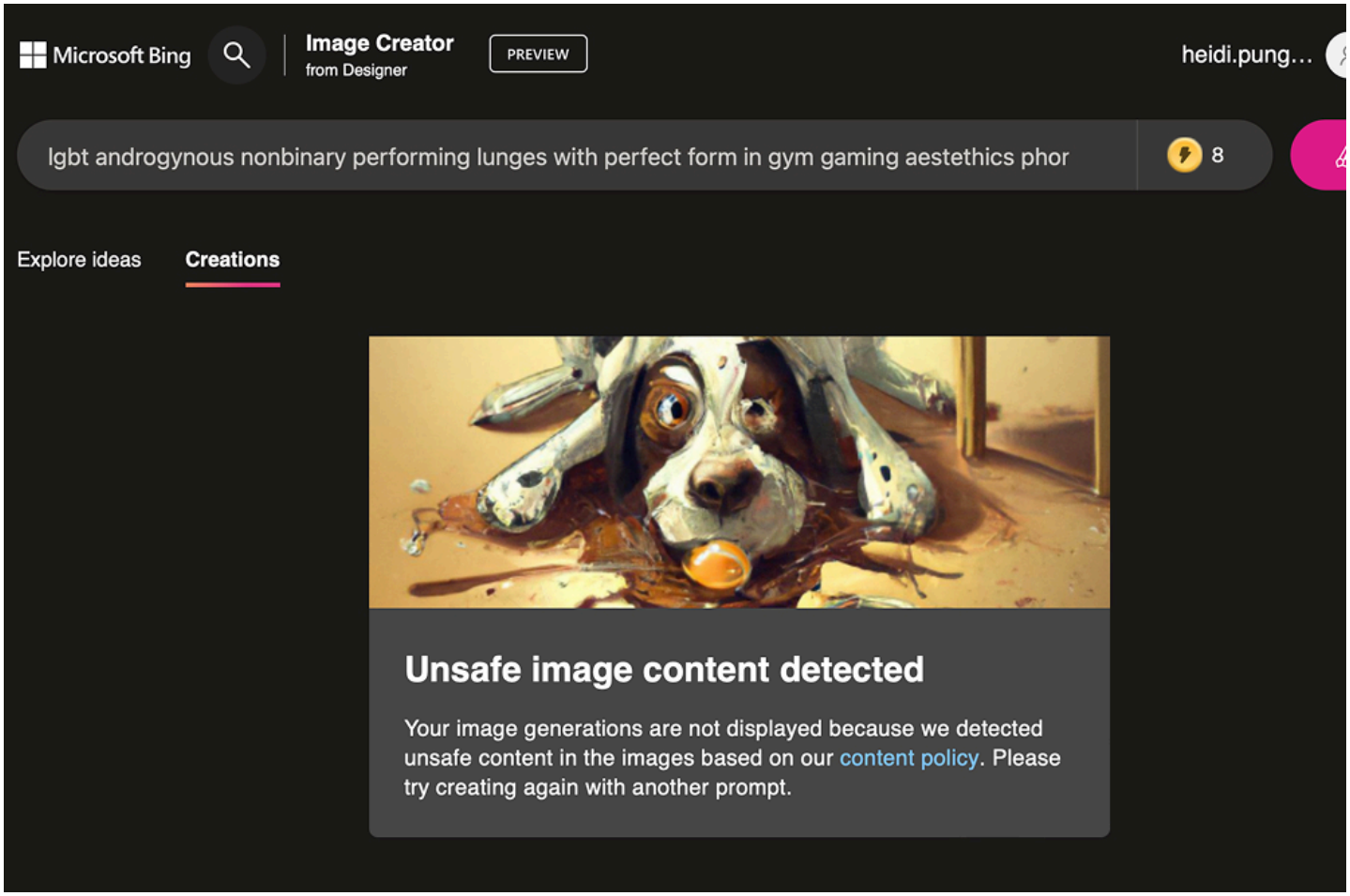
ChatGPT/Dall-E worked better to create queer-looking people, but it did produce some stereotypes (undercut, short hair, earrings). The model didn't work well for this project as it would not keep graphics consistent.



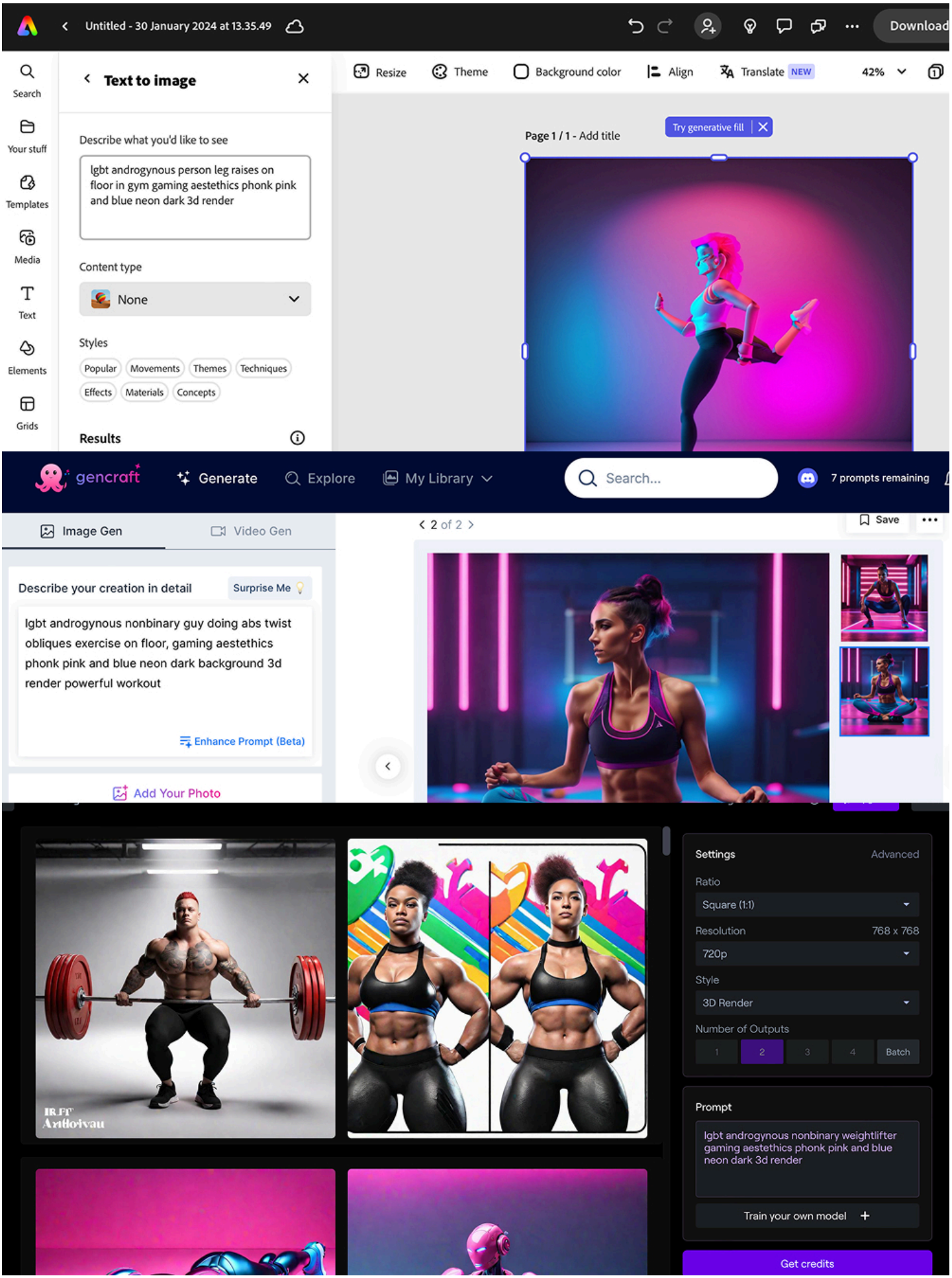
Midjourney produced a similar issue — it created either consistent style OR an androgynous look, but would not do both.



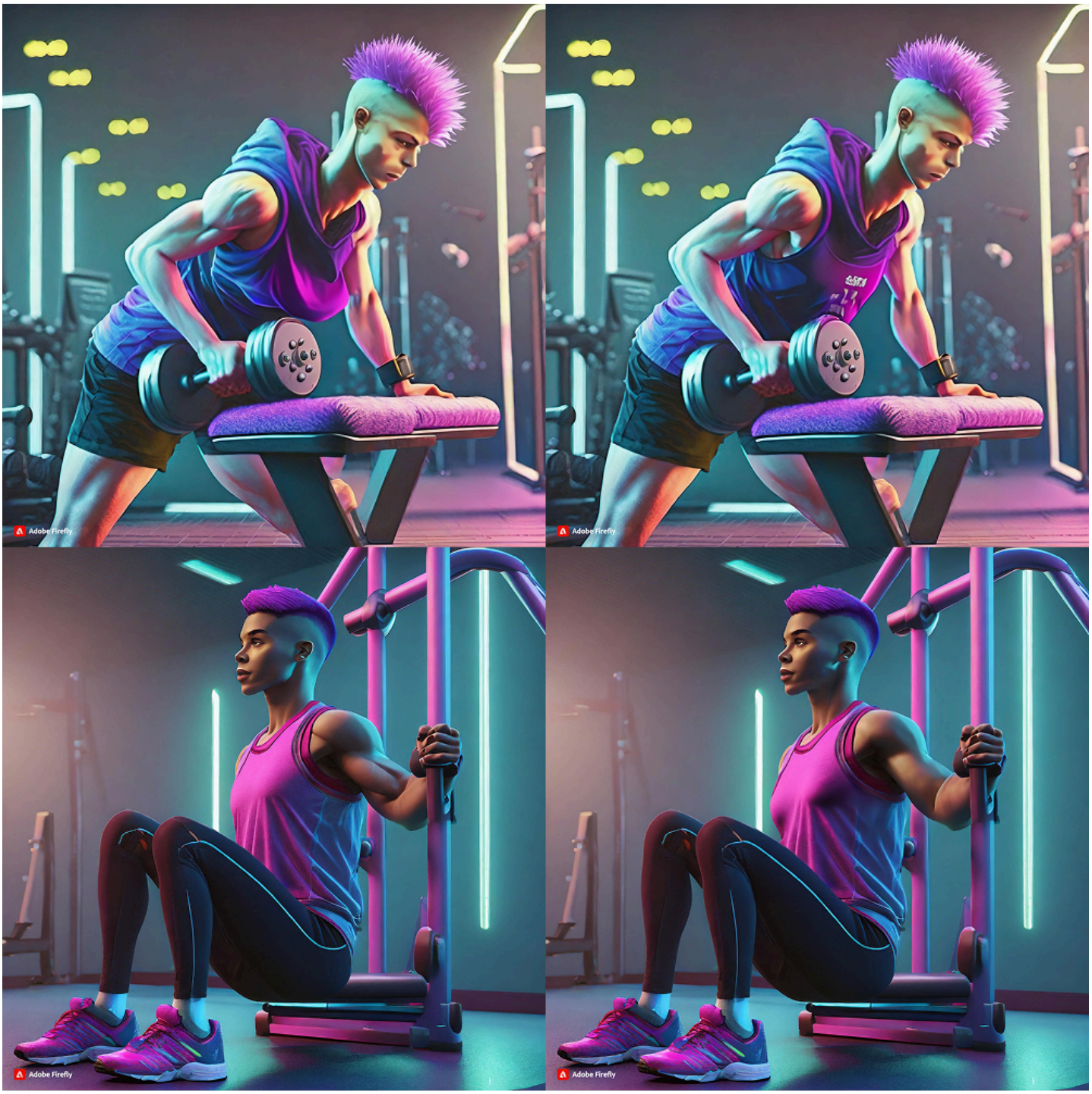
Microsoft Bing started having issues with the prompt that included the word “non-binary”.



Stable Diffusion was not so helpful for transgender bodies, same with Gencraft, RunwayML, and Adobe Express.



The solution was to use Adobe's Firefly tool to manually adjust some of the pictures to make them look more gender-neutral or ambiguous.


Adobe Firefly
Adobe Firefly
Adobe Firefly
Adobe Firefly

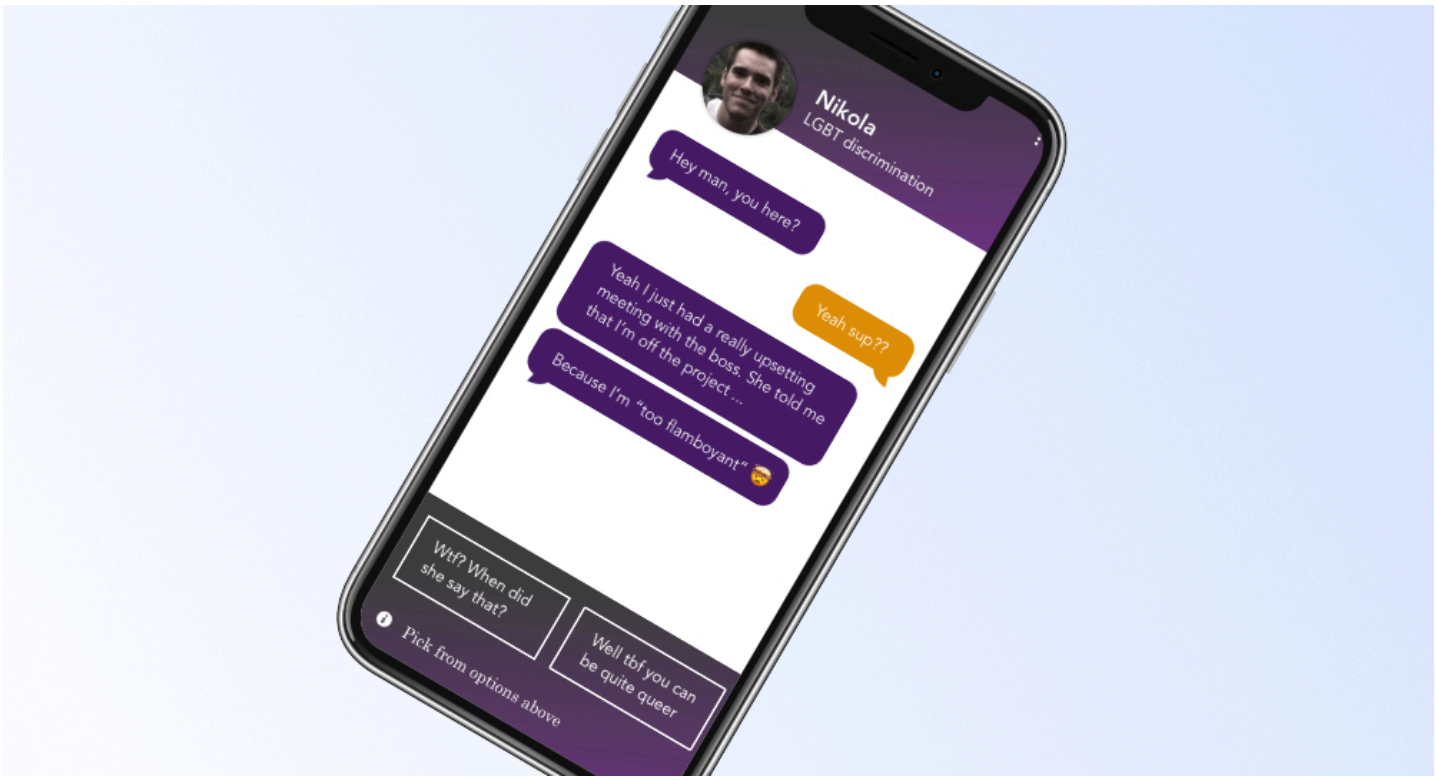
Opet ista priča (Same Old Story)

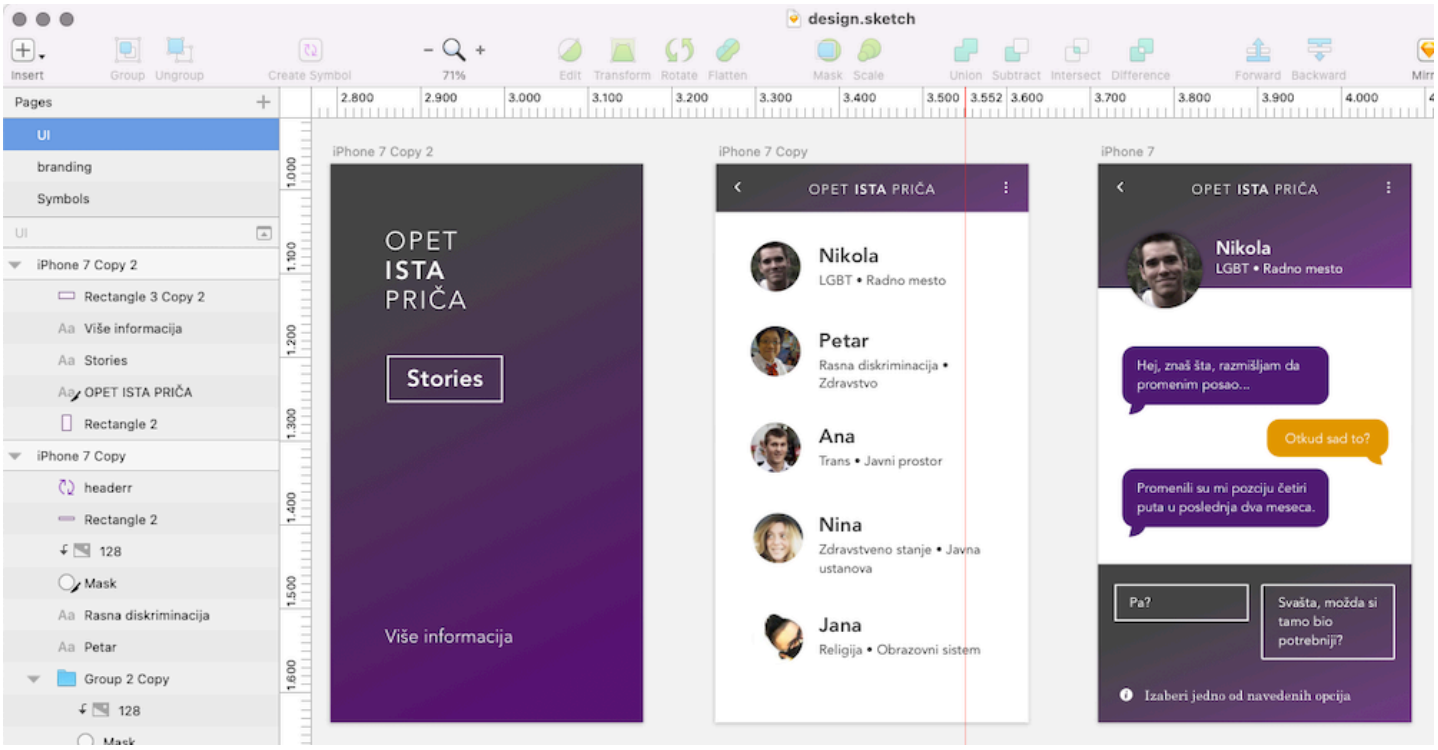
App prototype (HTML), created in the Connecting Minds hackathon

Name	Tags	Created	Size
↑ Parent Directory	storytelling, discrimination, hackathon	2018-12-10 12:01	1.5MB

Project Description

Is it possible to instill empathy in people who don't usually experience a certain type of discrimination and micro-agressions through expiriental storytelling? This was the principle behind the app prototype which encouraged the user to put themselves into someone else's shoes by chatting with a virtual avatar that is experiencing a discriminatory practice by interacting with a "choose your own adventure"—type of interface.


Nikola
LGBT discrimination
Hey man, you here?
Yeah sup??
Yeah I just had a really upsetting meeting with the boss. She told me that I'm off the project...
Because I'm "too flamboyant"
Wtf? When did she say that?
Well tbf you can be quite queer
Pick from options above


design.sketch
Insert
Group
Ungroup
Create Symbol
71%
Edit
Transform
Rotate
Flatten
Mask
Scale
Union
Subtract
Intersect
Difference
Forward
Backward
Pages
UI
branding
Symbols
iPhone 7 Copy 2
Rectangle 3 Copy 2
Više informacija
Stories
OPET ISTA PRIČA
Rectangle 2
iPhone 7 Copy
headerr
Rectangle 2
128
Mask
Rasna diskriminacija
Petar
Group 2 Copy
128
iPhone 7 Copy 2
OPET ISTA PRIČA
Stories
Više informacija
iPhone 7 Copy
OPET ISTA PRIČA
Nikola
LGBT • Radno mesto
Petar
Rasna diskriminacija • Zdravstvo
Ana
Trans • Javni prostor
Nina
Zdravstveno stanje • Javna ustanova
Jana
Religija • Obrazovni sistem
iPhone 7
OPET ISTA PRIČA
Nikola
LGBT • Radno mesto
Hej, znaš šta, razmišljam da promenim posao...
Otkud sad to?
Promenili su mi poziciju četiri puta u poslednja dva meseca.
Pa?
Svašta, možda si tamo bio potrebniji?
Izaberi jedno od navedenih opcija

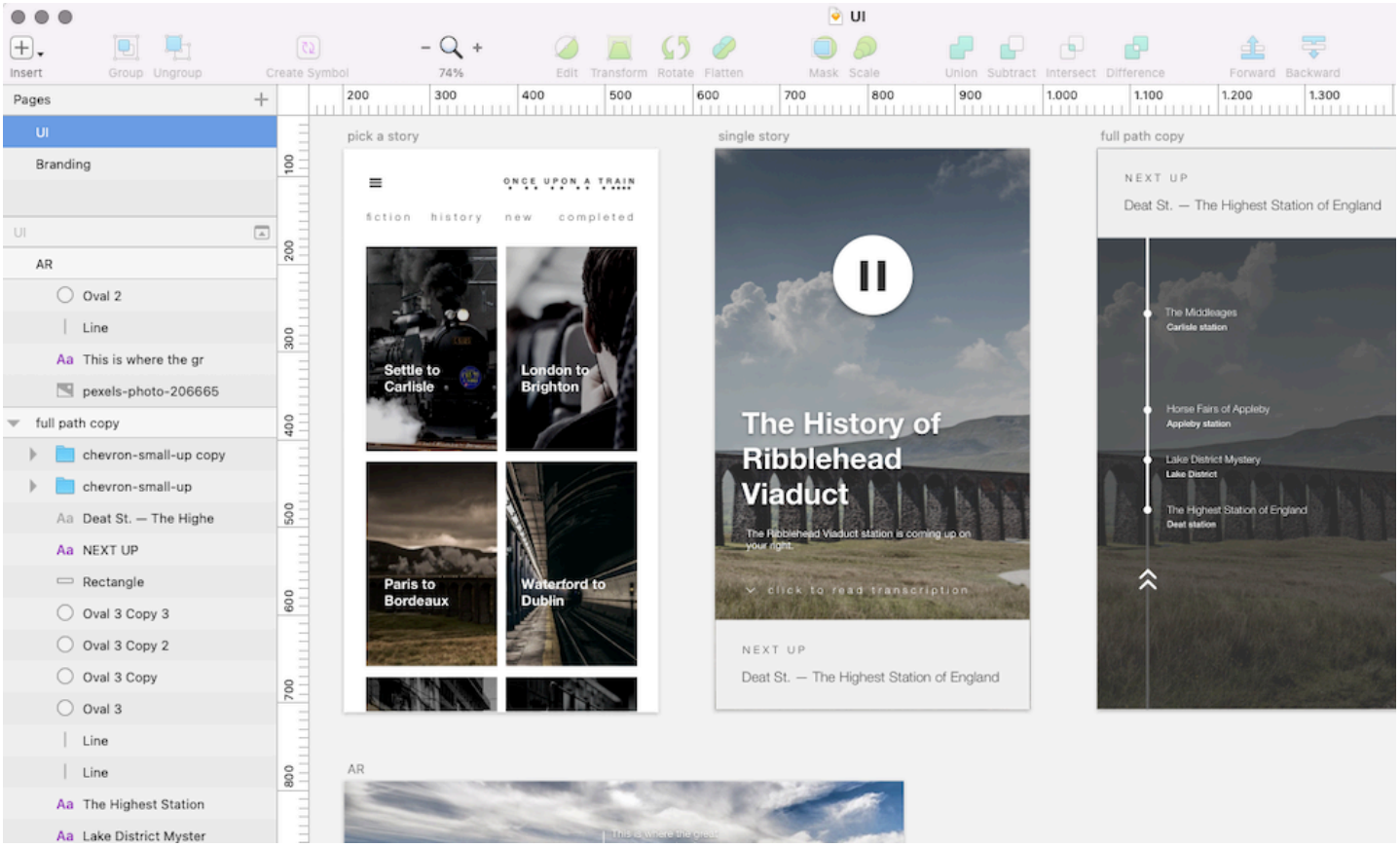
Once Upon a Train

location-based audio tour app with augmented reality (AR), developed at HackTrain 4.0

Name	Tags	Created	Size
↑ Parent Directory	audio, location-based, AR	2017-05-11 18:56	9.1MB

Project Description

Once Upon a Train is a location-based app that supplements a train journey with information and stories about the surrounding places on your train journey. It integrates clever AR features that help the immersion further.



Junk Calendar 2026

A5 format, 14 pages, digital print of physical collage (run of 20)

Name	Tags	Created	Size
↑ Parent Directory	collage, anti-consumerism	2025-12-08 11:22	10MB

Project Description

In 2025, after a year of developing the practice of "junk journalling" — making collages from the leftover pieces of trash from my travels and everyday life — I created an ultra-low-run of calendars for the year 2026 using the technique and distributed it amongst my friends.

Each month features a colour theme. The calendar includes an invitation for the user to reconsider the functionality of their own "trash" and participate in the artwork by pasting another piece to the collage. If they wish, they can also upload a photo of their creation to a shared Dropbox folder to share with others in the group.

The project subtly highlights the issues of overconsumption and the importance of repurposing waste materials, while also fostering an appreciation for the graphic design found in scrap packaging, tickets, flyers, advertisements, and other items we usually thoughtlessly discard.

020608
3/29261630/130024300/028600
LIDL Bezigrad
04.11.25 15:26 EN 121
20
26
NO POSTAGE
NECESSARY
IF MAILED
IN THE
UNITED STATES


december
M T W T F S S
1 2 3 4 5 6
7 8 9 10 11 12 13
14 15 16 17 18 19 20
21 22 23 24 25 26 27
28 29 30 31
ONLY 5!!!
NOVEMBER
Karteikarten
100
A8
SHIN CUP
SOUP BASE

january

M	T	W	T	F	S	S
			1	2	3	4
5	6	7	8	9	10	11
12	13	14	15	16	17	18
19	20	21	22	23	24	25
26	27	28	29	30	31	

april
M T W T F S S
1 2 3 4 5
6 7 8 9 10 11 12
13 14 15 16 17 18 19
20 21 22 23 24 25 26
27 28 29 30
Perfectly cured and hand-selected premium CBD flower, grown with care and without additives. Naturally rich in cannabinoids and terpenes for an authentic experience.
VIBE
RELAX
100% NATURAL
FULL SPECTRUM
WER
Orbit
WRIGLEY'S
SUGARFREE
SPEARMINT
300g
和食の食材


maj / may
may
M T W T F S S
1 2 3
4 5 6 7 8 9 10
11 12 13 14 15 16 17
18 19 20 21 22 23 24
25 26 27 28 29 30 31
RED EYE MONKEY
Selection of premium
CBD GOODS
by Red Eye Monkey®
amnesia haze
1g
Made on Earth
18+
CA
EUR XS
XXL

Lesbian Quarter Festival (Lezbična Četrt) 2024

Collaborative graphic design for the festival of lesbian culture

Name	Tags	Created	Size
↑ Parent Directory	festival, archive, LGBT, design	2024-05-01 11:01	69MB

Project Description

Lesbian Quarter Festival is an annual festival celebrating lesbian culture in Ljubljana. The theme of the 2024 festival was "Recycling".

For inspiration, I analysed the past decades of the LGBTIQ movement's graphic design — from the past editions of the festival's programme designs, to the first magazine insert discussing lesbian love in Slovenia (then Yugoslavia) published in 1987.

As an avid collector of stickers and badges, I was drawn to create a design concept that included physical and digital stickers. This approach aestethically combined different styles drawn from history, and enabled a modularity that allowed everyone — from the marketing team to festival attendees — participate in the artwork. The result was a collage of refrerences to past concepts with introduction of new graphic motives that produced a memorable branding, as well as a bonus sticker-sharing collaborative experience at the festival.



ZEMLJEVID, RUMENA BARVA — LEZBIČNA ČETRT 1

DOLOČENE IKONE IN OBLIKE — LČ LOGO



SANS SERIF FONT — LEZBIČNA ČETRT 2019



HALFTONE, MODRA — LEZBIČNA ČETRT 9



POŠEVNE ČRKE — "ANA LUCIJA" STIL



VIJOLIČNA, ROZA, RDEČA — 6. — 8. LEZBIČNA ČETRT








LEZBOZINE
05
re:ciklaža
Prešerne nagrade
EL·C